



clean water to prevent paint from drying with a hard edge.

Splattering

Flicking paint from a loaded paintbrush onto a picture to produce blots and patterns useful for texture.

Sponging

Pressing a sponge dipped in paint onto paper to create a mottled mark that is good for creating texture.

Squirrel brush

A very soft brush made from squirrel hair. Squirrel brushes do not hold much paint but are good for softening and blending colors.

Strengthening

Building up layers of paint to make colors stronger. This is

frequently done because paint colors become paler when they dry.

Stretching

The method of wetting paper with a damp sponge, taping it to a board, and letting it dry flat. Stretching paper helps to keep the paper from buckling when you paint on it.

Students' colors

A cheaper range of paints than Artists' colors. Students' colors do not contain the same high level of pigments as Artists' colors and therefore do not produce such good results.

Toned paper

Paper that has a colored surface. White paint has to be added to colored paints

to make the lightest tones on such paper.

Tone

The relative lightness or darkness of a color. The tone of a color can be altered by diluting it with water or mixing it with a darker pigment.

Viewfinder

A framing device that can be used to show how a subject will look in a variety of compositions before painting. A simple viewfinder can be made by cutting a rectangular hole in a piece of cardboard.

Warm colors

Colors with a reddish or orange tone. Warm colors appear to come forward in a painting and can be used to help create a sense of depth.

Wax resist

Method of using candle wax to prevent the surface of the paper from accepting paint. Once applied, the wax cannot be removed.

Wet-in-wet

Adding layers of color onto wet paper or paint that is still wet. This method makes it possible to build up paintings quickly with soft colors, but it is less predictable than painting over paint that has already dried.

Wet on dry

Adding layers of paint on top of color that has already dried. Painting in this way produces vivid colors with strong edges, so the method can be used to build up a painting with a high level of accuracy.

